

Chapter 8-1

The eye-catching gaudy green luxury car stopped at the side of Yunding Building¹. Liang Shi unbuckled her seatbelt and glanced at Xu Qingzhu.

Xu Qingzhu's voice was flat, "I promised you, so I'll do it."

Those eyes were cold, staring intently at Liang Shi as she said this.

Liang Shi: "....."

It felt like she was being warned.

She cleared her throat softly, "I'll contact you after I get things clear. Just wait in the car for a moment, I'll be quick."

"Got it." Xu Qingzhu closed her eyes, her eyelashes trembling slightly. Even though she had put on makeup when coming out, she still looked tired, "Go ahead."

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Liang Shi called Xu Qingya again, asking for her specific location.

"I'm at the KFC on the first floor." Xu Qingya asked: "Liang Shi jiejie², what do you want to drink? I'll order it for you."

"No need." Liang Shi said, "Just stay there and don't move. I'll be right over."

"I can see you. I'm at the third table from the entrance." Xu Qingya reported her location herself.

"Okay."

Liang Shi hung up the phone, and through the clean KFC window, she immediately spotted Xu Qingya.

She was easy to recognize—she was the only girl in the entire KFC holding a phone.

Liang Shi jogged a few steps, pushed open the KFC door, and Xu Qingya immediately waved at her.

The moment Liang Shi got a clear look at Xu Qingya's outfit, she suddenly understood why the original body and Xu Qingya could get along so well.

Their aesthetic tastes were completely on the same wavelength!

Xu Qingya had dirty braids³, wearing ripped denim shorts that exposed her long legs to the air, and a tight off-shoulder T-shirt on top. Her collarbone was covered in glitter, and her makeup was heavy.

She looked nothing like Xu Qingzhu.

Through the heavy makeup, her features barely resembled Xu Qingzhu's.

This fifteen-year-old girl looked like she was in her twenties, dressed with a maturity beyond her age.

"Liang Shi jiejie." Xu Qingya showed a sweet smile, then asked warily: "You came alone, right?"

Liang Shi sat across from her somewhat uncomfortably, nodded, and directly changed the topic, "What do you need the money for?"

"I already said, my dad stopped my card." Xu Qingya snorted lightly, "I don't have anywhere to stay, so I need to go to a hotel."

"Why did your dad stop your card?" Liang Shi asked.

If she hadn't met Xu Qingya, Liang Shi might have thought there was something wrong with the Xu family parents, perhaps they were too authoritarian or something.

But now that she had seen Xu Qingya, she felt she might have been prejudiced.

"My dad threw away all of Xuanxuan's⁴ merchandise and tore up Xuanxuan's posters." Xu Qingya got angry just talking about this, tears welling up in her eyes, "I spent all my allowance to get those things, he went too far."

Liang Shi: "....."

Another crazy fan.

"Then why didn't you dare let your sister know?" Liang Shi probed: "Does your sister also oppose you chasing stars?"

Xu Qingya scoffed, "My sister doesn't care. She'll only consider things from my parents' perspective and will definitely think I'm being unreasonable. She's just my parents' obedient daughter."

After saying this, Xu Qingya looked at Liang Shi pleadingly, "Liang jiejie, you'll help me, right?"

She even blinked her eyes that were heavily made up.

Although Liang Shi was used to stage makeup, it was all much more refreshing than this.

It was obvious that Xu Qingya was still a makeup novice, and the makeup she applied was too heavy, appearing somewhat greasy.

"I can help you." Liang Shi first gave a definitive answer, making Xu Qingya happy, but quickly, Liang Shi changed her tone, "But you have to wash off the makeup on your face, change your clothes, and then come with me to see your sister."

Xu Qingya's face quickly fell.

"Liang jiejie, you weren't like this before." Xu Qingya said dejectedly: "You used to just give me money directly, but this time..."

She paused, very alertly, "Did my sister force you?"

Liang Shi shook her head: "Your sister and I are married, so we need to respect each other. There's no forcing involved."

Xu Qingya looked certain, "I don't believe it."

Liang Shi: ".....?"

"Your sister is so gentle, what misunderstanding do you have about her?" Liang Shi didn't understand.

The Xu Qingzhu she saw had a cold personality, but that was because the original body had done too many things to hurt her, almost causing her death, so it was understandable that she kept a cold face toward her.

But Xu Qingzhu was very gentle in front of Zhao Xuning and Bai Weiwei.

Even toward Cheng Ran, she would politely greet her.

She was completely considerate of her own face.

This was gentleness that seeped from her bones.

Liang Shi really appreciated such gentle girls.

Now it was Xu Qingya's turn to be shocked, "You actually think my sister is gentle. What misunderstanding do you have about her?"

Liang Shi: "....."

Time was tight, so Liang Shi didn't have time to discuss with Xu Qingya whether Xu Qingzhu was gentle or not.

Moreover, she always trusted what she saw with her own eyes rather than what others said.

She was used to evaluating what kind of person someone was after getting along with them.

"I can give you this money." Liang Shi said: "But you have to listen to me."

Xu Qingya frowned, "Then forget it, I'll find someone else."

"Who?" Liang Shi asked.

"Friends." Xu Qingya answered casually, then used words to provoke her, "Since you won't give me money anyway, what does it matter to you who I find?"

Liang Shi fell silent.

When Xu Qingya walked outside, she inconspicuously followed behind her.

When she came out of the hospital, she had already changed clothes for convenience.

She was wearing a light hoodie and jeans, a very casual outfit. With her physical fitness, she easily walked ahead of Xu Qingya.

From the corner of her eye, Liang Shi saw Xu Qingzhu sitting in the car.

She was staring intently in this direction.

Liang Shi blocked Xu Qingya's path, "When I said listen to me, I didn't mean for you to go home, I just wanted to sit down and talk."

"Talk about what?"

"I'll get you a room, how about you meet with your sister first?" Liang Shi said: "Your sister hasn't seen you for a long time and misses you."

"So, my sister came?" Xu Qingya immediately caught the key point in her words.

Liang Shi nodded, "Yes."

Xu Qingya's vigorous attitude immediately deflated.

"Giving money is a small matter." Liang Shi adopted a conciliatory policy, "Family members can't keep being estranged like this forever. If you meet with your sister, she will help you."

Xu Qingya was somewhat swayed.

Liang Shi continued: "I'll help you find a hotel and give you money. For the days when you don't want to go home, I'll help you."

This temptation was too great.

Xu Qingya finally couldn't resist and nodded.

Footnotes: ¹ Yunding Building: "云顶大厦" literally means "Cloud Peak Building," a typical name for a commercial high-rise in Chinese cities ² Jiejie: "姐姐" meaning "older sister," used as a respectful way to address older females ³ Dirty braids: A hairstyle with deliberately messy or textured braids, popular in certain fashion subcultures ⁴ Xuanxuan: "绚绚" appears to be the stage name of Xu Qingya's idol, with "绚" meaning "gorgeous" or "brilliant"